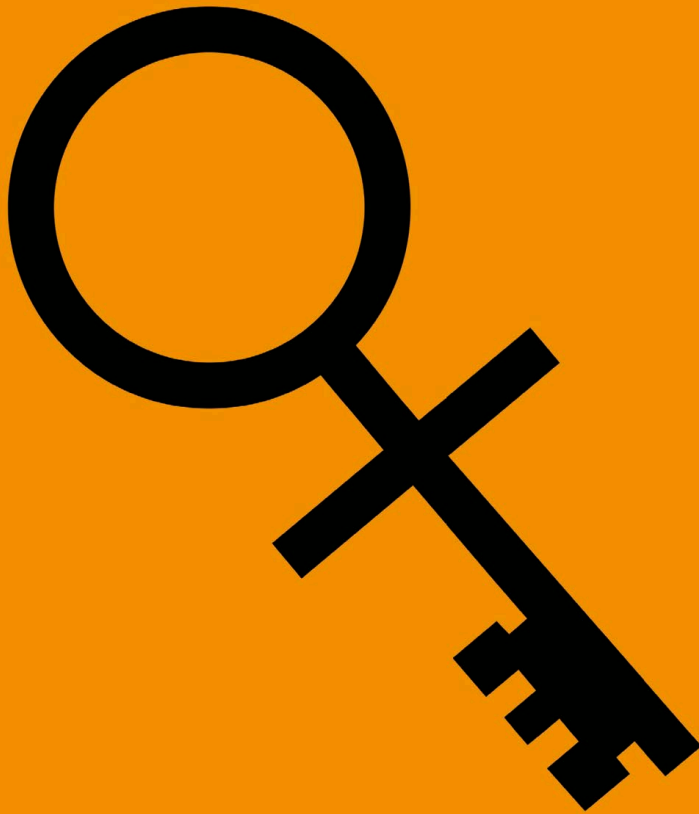


THE RIGHT OF A WOMAN TO DECIDE

ROE V. WADE (1973)



IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Civil rights

BEFORE

1821 Connecticut is the first US state to outlaw abortion.

1900 Abortion is illegal in all US states.

1967 Colorado is the first US state to legalize abortion.

AFTER

1976 The Hyde Amendment halts federal funding of abortions in the US.

1990 Abortions carried out in the US peak at more than 1.6 million per year.

2019 A US federal judge blocks President Trump's "conscience rule," which would allow healthcare providers to refuse abortions on moral grounds.

The right to vote aside, no issue has more obviously defined the struggle for women's rights in the modern world than abortion. But whereas the demand for votes for women was fought (and won in many countries) in the early years of the 20th century, the legal right to abortion only came to the fore in the 1960s. It would become an absolute touchstone of what was originally called Women's Liberation and is now known as feminism. To this day, abortion remains possibly the prime focus of all assertions of female equality.

Throughout history, women confronted with unwanted or unexpected pregnancies faced the prospect of a blighted life, especially if they lacked financial support. If disowned by the child's